FRANCE DIAGNOSTIC · UAE → PARIS

Diagnostic example — *fictional house*

What the house receives at the end of the two-week Diagnostic: a written decision (launch, adjust or wait), the reasons behind it, and what remains to be settled.

THE HOUSE · ENTIRELY FICTIONAL

Bayt Ghaymah

An oud house founded in Dubai.

14 fragrances: eaux de parfum, oils and bakhoor.

4 boutiques in Dubai and Abu Dhabi, and an online store.

Bestselling 100 ml eau de parfum: AED 1,150 in Dubai.

Plan: Paris first, then the rest of France.

PLEASE NOTE

- Bayt Ghaymah is a fictional brand: its figures and the findings illustrate the shape of the deliverable. Market figures are real, with their source on the last page.

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01 · THE DECISION

Launch, *compliance first.*

Bayt Ghaymah can sell in Paris at a price that holds. One condition comes before everything else: the products must be compliant for Europe before the first sale.

OUR DECISION

LAUNCH

The project holds: the 90-day launch can be planned, once the conditions below are met.

ADJUST

The project holds only if what is written below changes.

WAIT

A blocking point must be solved before any budget is committed.

WHY

1. **The price holds in Paris.** At €240 for the 100 ml, the house sits inside the market corridor: the same niche perfume costs 8% to 23% more in Dubai than in Paris [1]. Its Dubai price, simply converted, would sit above it.
2. **Paris has a clear way in.** Independent niche perfumeries and concept stores first, around a launch moment with the press and creators.
3. **The story is its own.** In Paris, oud is often told by European houses. A house from the Gulf that grew up with it has a different story to tell, and buyers ask for one.
4. **The house has the means.** Stock available, a budget for a launch moment, and a founder ready to meet the Paris press.

THE CONDITIONS

1. **Compliance before any sale**
   An EU Responsible Person, the CPNP notification, the product information file and safety assessment, French labelling and the extended allergen labelling.
2. **A short launch range**
   5 fragrances out of 14, chosen among those whose formula passes the safety assessment unchanged.
3. **A Paris price set from the shelf**
   €240 for the 100 ml, rather than the Dubai price converted (≈ €279).

> **In every case, before the first sales meeting:** protect the trademark in the EU or in France.

WHAT WOULD HAVE CHANGED THE DECISION

Adjust, if the house had kept its Dubai price converted, or if a fragrance the launch relies on had needed reformulation.

Wait, if compliance could not be completed before the launch window, or if no budget were available for the launch moment and the samples.

02 · THE SHELF PRICE

Start from the shelf, *not from the Dubai price.*

The question: at what price should the 100 ml sit on a Paris shelf, and what does the house keep from it?

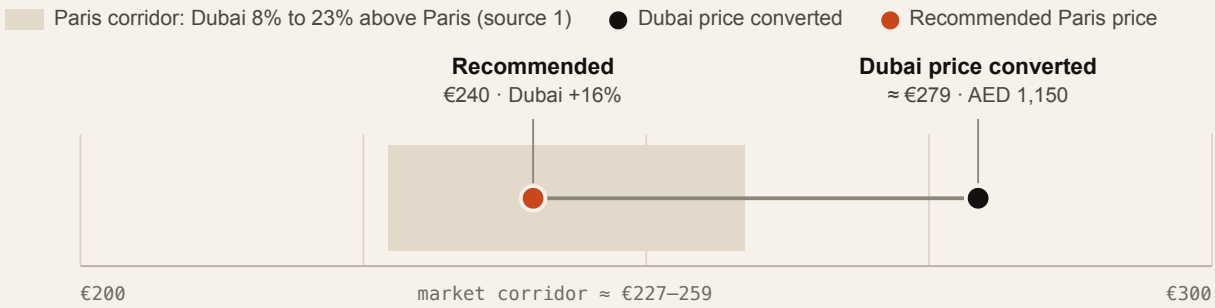
8–23%

more in Dubai than in Paris, for the same niche perfume. Read the other way: comparable niche perfumes sell for less in Paris. That is the corridor we read from. [1]

€240

the Paris shelf price we recommend for the 100 ml, against ≈ €279 for the Dubai price converted.

Paris shelf price for the 100 ml eau de parfum · in euros, including VAT



THE READING, IN FIVE LINES

100 ML	DUBAI PRICE CONVERTED	RECOMMENDED
Dubai shelf price	AED 1,150	AED 1,150
Paris shelf price, incl. VAT	≈ €279	€240
Dubai above Paris	0%	+16%
Wholesale price to a perfumery, excl. VAT	≈ €140	≈ €120
Against the 8–23% corridor	**above**	**inside**

Wholesale price: the Paris shelf price divided by a coefficient close to two.

WHAT THE PRICE CHAIN CONTAINS

From the house to the Paris shelf: transport to France, the EU compliance files, a logistics partner in France, the margin of the point of sale, and French VAT.

In French selective perfumery, the public price including VAT is close to twice the wholesale price excluding VAT [2]. At €240 on the shelf, the house sells at about €120 to the perfumery and keeps control of its price: no distributor buys the stock.

One public price on every channel: the house's online store does not sell below the stores in France. In a real mission, this page also gives the price channel by channel and the references compared.

03 · WHO BUYS, AND WHERE

Paris discovers a house *through its press.*

France asks three things of a Gulf house: is it compliant, who puts it on the shelf, and who will talk about it. Here is who buys, where, and who tells the story.

WHO BUYS

Paris niche perfume lovers

They know oud from European houses and look for the real craft.

THEY EXPECT

A story, rare materials, advice in store.

WHERE

Independent niche perfumeries, concept stores, department store beauty floors.

Visitors and residents from the Gulf

Some know the house from home and buy during a stay in Paris.

THEY EXPECT

The same fragrances and the same service as in Dubai.

WHERE

Department stores, hotel boutiques, the house's online store.

Gift buyers

They look for a way into the house, and a gift that explains itself.

THEY EXPECT

A discovery set, quick and clear advice.

WHERE

Concept stores, department stores, online.

WHERE TO SELL, IN THE ORDER OF OPENING

FIRST	**Independent niche perfumeries**	Three or four addresses where an unknown house is tried, with advice. Buyers ask why this house and why now; they want testers, trained staff and a story to tell.
NEXT	**Concept stores and hotel boutiques**	An international clientele and a setting for the story. The natural place for a pop-up during the launch.
TO PREPARE	**Department store beauty floor**	A pop-up first, then a corner. The buyer file is built during the launch; a listing takes time and is part of representation.
NOT NOW	**Selective perfumery chains**	They expect sales evidence and an in-store activation plan.
IN SUPPORT	**The house's online store, delivering in France**	Only once compliant. The same price as in stores; each point of sale has its own code.
AROUND IT	**Press and creators**	Beauty and lifestyle press, perfume critics and specialist writers, creators. A press preview, then an evening with creators; the story is written for French readers. We commit to the work, never to a number of articles.

Profiles and channel order: an illustrative reading, invented for the example. In a real mission, each channel carries its addresses, its buyers and what they ask for.

04 · THE COMPETITIVE FRAME

On the shelf, *next to whom?*

We read the shelf by category, not by name. What matters is what the customer compares, bottle in hand.

CATEGORY	WHERE IT SELLS	WHAT THE CUSTOMER COMPARES	WHAT IT MEANS FOR BAYT GHAYMAH
Luxury houses' oud collections	Department stores, own boutiques	The name, the bottle, the service	They set what oud means in Paris, and the price ceiling. Compete on authenticity, not on prestige.
Established European niche houses	Niche perfumeries, online	The story, the materials, the price	The direct comparison: the price corridor is read here.
Gulf houses already present in Europe	Department stores, own boutiques, online	Richness, longevity, the oud itself	They show the demand exists. Bayt Ghaymah must say what is its own.
Mass-market oud and lookalikes	Everywhere, at low prices	Price alone	They make oud common: the house needs a clear reason to pay more.
Artisan perfumers and attar specialists	Small boutiques, online, fairs	Purity, natural materials	Close in spirit: the house's craft must be shown, not claimed.

Where the house sits · a qualitative reading, no figures



OUR READING

An Emirati oud house, at the price of established niche houses.

- **What justifies the price:** a craft that grew up with oud; oils and bakhoor alongside the eaux de parfum; a ritual and advice in store.
- **What is missing:** a story written for French readers, and sales material in French.
- **What sets it apart:** it comes from a place where oud is a daily ritual, not a trend.

What we do not do: judge a named competitor. The diagnostic compares categories and surveyed prices, never one brand against another. **In a real mission**, this page rests on the references surveyed on shelves and online, in Paris and in Dubai, brought to the same size.

05 · THE THREE RISKS

What can make the launch fail, *and what reduces it.*

1

Selling before being compliant

LEVEL: **HIGH**

WHAT CAN HAPPEN

A product sold without an EU Responsible Person, a CPNP notification or the right labelling can be withdrawn from sale. Oud oils and rose carry allergens that must be declared.

THE SIGNAL TO WATCH

A formula that needs changes after the safety assessment; labels not ready in French.

WHAT REDUCES IT

Compliance before any sale, with a regulatory specialist. A launch range whose formulas pass unchanged.

2

A price above the market

LEVEL: **MEDIUM**

WHAT CAN HAPPEN

At the Dubai price converted, the house sits above comparable niche perfumes in Paris. Buyers ask for discounts; an online price undercuts the stores.

THE SIGNAL TO WATCH

Slow sell-through in the first weeks; discount requests; online prices below the stores.

WHAT REDUCES IT

The Paris price set from the shelf. One public price on every channel. A price survey every quarter.

3

Not being heard

LEVEL: **HIGH**

WHAT CAN HAPPEN

Paris sees many oud launches. Without press, creators and trial, buyers do not reorder.

THE SIGNAL TO WATCH

No press pick-up after the preview; few reorders after the first weeks.

WHAT REDUCES IT

A launch moment, samples and a discovery set, a story written for French readers, trained staff in each point of sale.

WHAT THE RULES ASK, AS POINTERS

An EU Responsible Person and the CPNP notification before the first sale; a product information file and a safety assessment; French labelling. Products newly placed on the EU market since 31 July 2026 must carry the extended fragrance allergen labelling of Regulation (EU) 2023/1545[3].

These are pointers, not advice. Legal, tax and regulatory points are confirmed with an adviser; the diagnostic says what to check, and in what order.

06 · ONCE COMPLIANT: THE 90-DAY LAUNCH

Ninety days, *to sell and be known.*

What the launch would cover, and in what order, once compliance is done. This is the logic; the detailed plan is built with the house.

1

MONTH ONE

Set up

- Logistics partner in France chosen by the house.
- Compliance files confirmed with the specialist.
- Paris price set, the same on every channel.
- Press kit and sales material in French.
- Sales team hired and trained; priority list of points of sale.

2

MONTH TWO

Make it known and tried

- A press preview, then an evening with creators.
- A pop-up in a concept store.
- Samples and a discovery set.
- First buyer meetings.

3

MONTH THREE

Sell and measure

- First orders, first restocks followed.
- Online store open in France; each point of sale has its own code.
- Department store buyer file prepared.
- Review at day 90.

Brand awareness

Launch moment, creators, content, press relations, pop-up: the house becomes visible where it is sold.

Sales

Points of sale, buyer meetings, orders, restocks, logistics: visibility turns into orders.

AT DAY 90

MEASURE

Sales by channel, points of sale opened, cost of a sale in the pop-up.

DECIDE

Continue, adjust, or move to representation.

PREPARE

A chain listing takes time: it is prepared from now.

A commitment to the work done.

Visits, days of activation, buyer meetings: their number is written in the scope and measured every month. Never a promise of sales volume or listings.

07 · OPEN QUESTIONS

What the diagnostic *leaves to decide.*

An honest diagnostic also says what it does not know yet. Each question has an owner and a deadline.

	QUESTION	WHO DECIDES	WHEN
1	**The launch range.** Which five fragrances? Two candidates may need reformulation: the safety assessor decides.	The house, with the specialist	Before the launch
2	**The EU Responsible Person.** A specialist provider, or an EU entity of the house?	The house, with an adviser	Month one
3	**Trademark protection** in the EU or in France: classes and timing.	The house and its counsel	Before any sales meeting
4	**The Paris price.** €240 for the 100 ml, and the price of the discovery set.	The house	Before the first buyer meeting
5	**The launch budget.** The launch moment, the samples, the pop-up.	The house	Before the launch
6	**The founder in Paris.** Presence at the press preview and at the first buyer meetings.	The house	Month one

WHAT HAPPENS NEXT

1
The house decides
The six questions above, each by its date.

2
Compliance
EU Responsible Person, CPNP notification, labels in French, with the specialist.

3
The 90-day launch
It starts once the products are compliant, following the logic of page 7.

SOURCES OF THE REAL FIGURES

1 Scena survey of public prices in Paris and Dubai, 5 niche perfumes, ECB rate of 15/10/2026 (4.1161 AED per €1), 16/10/2026.

2 Wholesale price excluding VAT to public price including VAT in French selective perfumery: a coefficient close to two. Autorité de la concurrence, decisions 06-D-04 and 07-D-03.

3 Fragrance allergen labelling: Commission Regulation (EU) 2023/1545 (EUR-Lex); application dates as published by the HPRA, the Irish regulator. A pointer, to check with an adviser.

4 EU Responsible Person and CPNP notification: the EU Cosmetics Regulation. A pointer, to check with an adviser.

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